

mentations for deserving people in your contact list and who are part of the LinkedIn network.

There are many nifty features on the site that work silently and unobtrusively, collecting and collating data and providing details on various aspects through your network connections. For example based on your job profile listing you can expect to see job opportunities from your network list popping up in your home page. You can also search for jobs or if you wish to find someone to work for your business or company you can use the various hiring services option that will enable you to get access to quality people. Barebones statistics of the progress of your network and the connections available through your contacts are also shown. When one or more friends add a same mutual friend, LinkedIn will ask you whether you know the mutual friend too!

Building a quality network will take time so you will need to be patient. However, if patience is not one of your virtues or you do need to contact a specific person whose profile you've just discovered then consider upgrading to a paid account which will enable you to contact the 11 million LinkedIn members directly.

5.3 Relationship Networking—Ryze.com

Ryze is one of the earliest business networking communities and still going strong. One of the strongest attractions for members is the sense of belonging that seems to flow within the Ryze community. This we suspect is the real secret sauce that has enabled Ryze to survive the onslaught of much more sophisticated and focused business networking sites like LinkedIn and Biznik.

After signing up, somewhat like LinkedIn your Ryze home page will show you the number of friends you have and in turn the friends they have plus any pending friend requests. As you start filling your profile this will start getting replaced with your personal details. To get around to building your network on Ryze,